

CUNY AI LAB

# Configuring skills and tools

New Media Lab · Room 7388.01
CUNY Graduate Center

Thursday, October 15, 2026 · 2:30–4:00 p.m. Eastern

**Developed by Zach Muhlbauer**

https://cuny-ai-lab.github.io/sandbox-series/skills

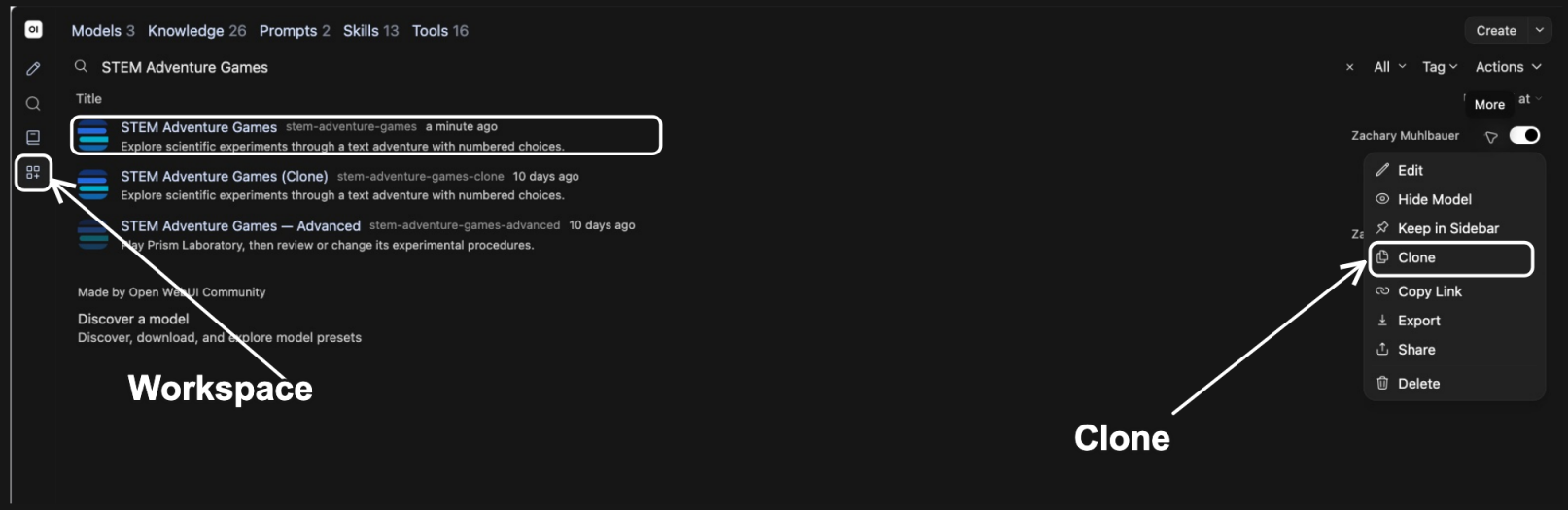
# Choose Your Own Adventure

Continue your saved model or clone it first

Open **Workspace → Models → Edit**
Read your actual system prompt
Identify setting, goals, and rules

Keep this model card open while you add a skill and a tool

Select **Workspace** in left sidebar, then **Models**. Search for **STEM Adventure Games**. Open ••• beside it and select **Clone**.



# What Is a Skill?

**Skills** contain plain-text instructions for repeatable tasks

| | |
|---|---|
| **Trigger** | Request or condition that starts a procedure |
| **Procedure** | Steps, checks, and points that require a question |
| **Output** | Required response content and form |

# Skill Examples

## Extend Adventure Games

Follow a saved adventure procedure

Call Adventure Kit as directed by the skill

Read the saved instructions in **Workspace → Skills**

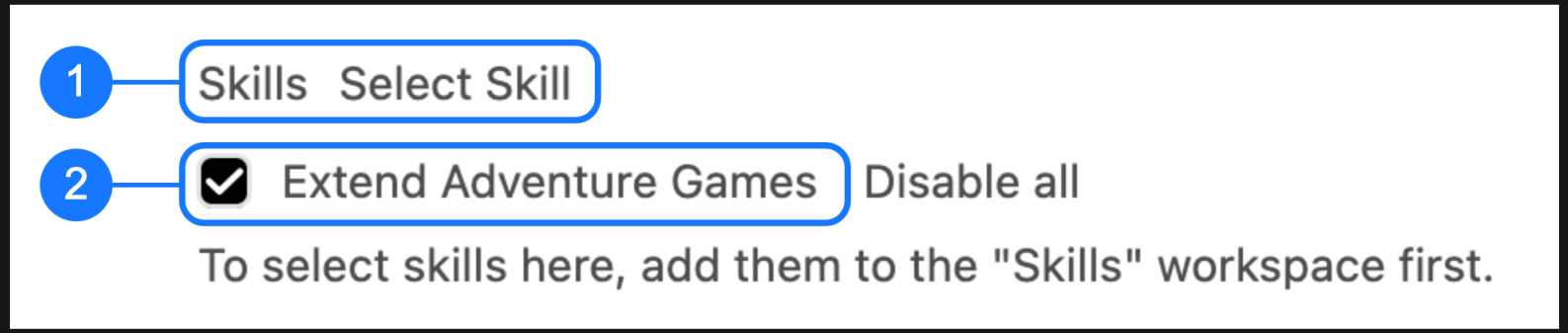
# Add Your Skill

In **Workspace → Models → Edit**, find **Skills → Select Skill**

Choose existing **Extend Adventure Games**

Read its saved instructions

Keep this model card open for Adventure Kit



# What Is a Tool?

When a model calls a **tool**, Sandbox executes a function and returns its result

**Tool calling**, otherwise known as **function calling**, sends a function name and arguments for execution

| | |
|---|---|
| **Input** | Arguments supplied to a function |
| **Execution** | Code that applies specified rules |
| **Result** | Returned output for a model to inspect |

# Tool Examples

Workspace → Tools

Examples from the host's catalog. Your list depends on access

**Adventure Kit** v2.0.0 8 hours ago

Create participant-defined choice adventures with configurable state, rules and endings. No built-in scenario.

**Chat Export** v0.3.1 21 hours ago

Saves chat content (headings, text, lists and tables) as a downloadable Word (.docx) or PDF file, plus Markdow...

**Instructional Toolset** v0.6.0 3 days ago

Deterministically lists and loads curriculum units for instructional AI models.

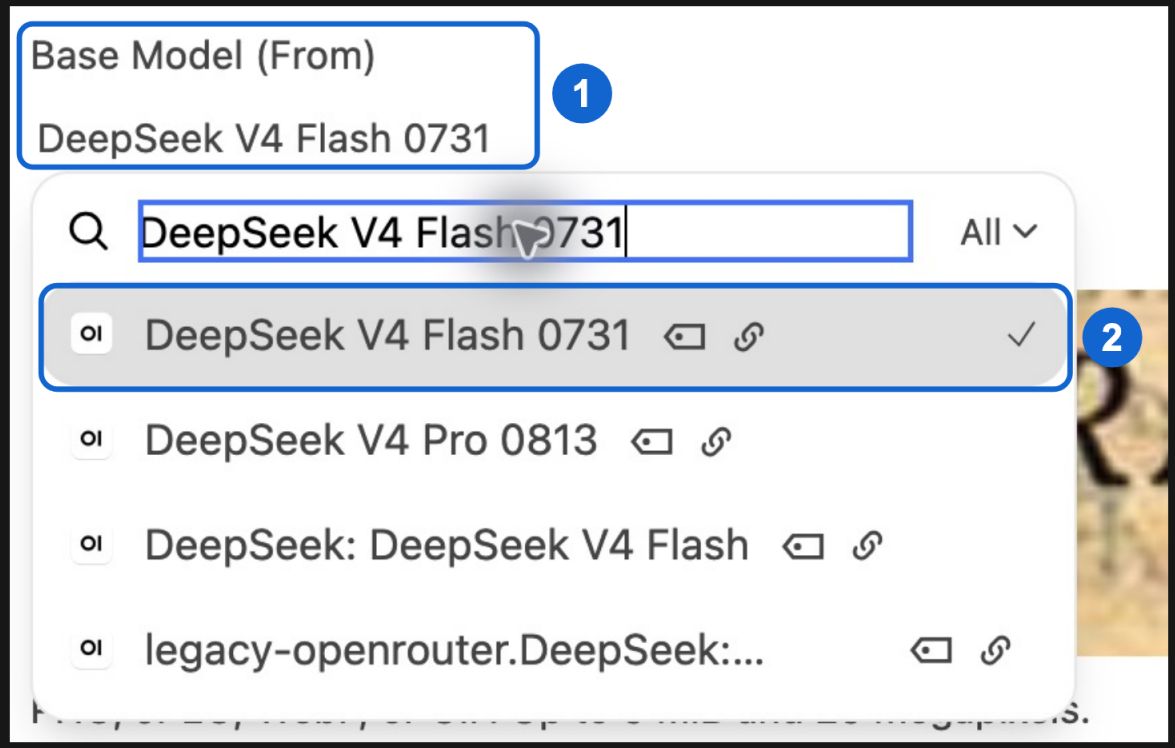
**Pronunciation and Translation Tool** ✨ v5.1.1 3 days ago

https://openwebui.com/posts/pronunciation_and_translation_tool_d8a83bca

**ChartJS** v2.0.0 2 months ago

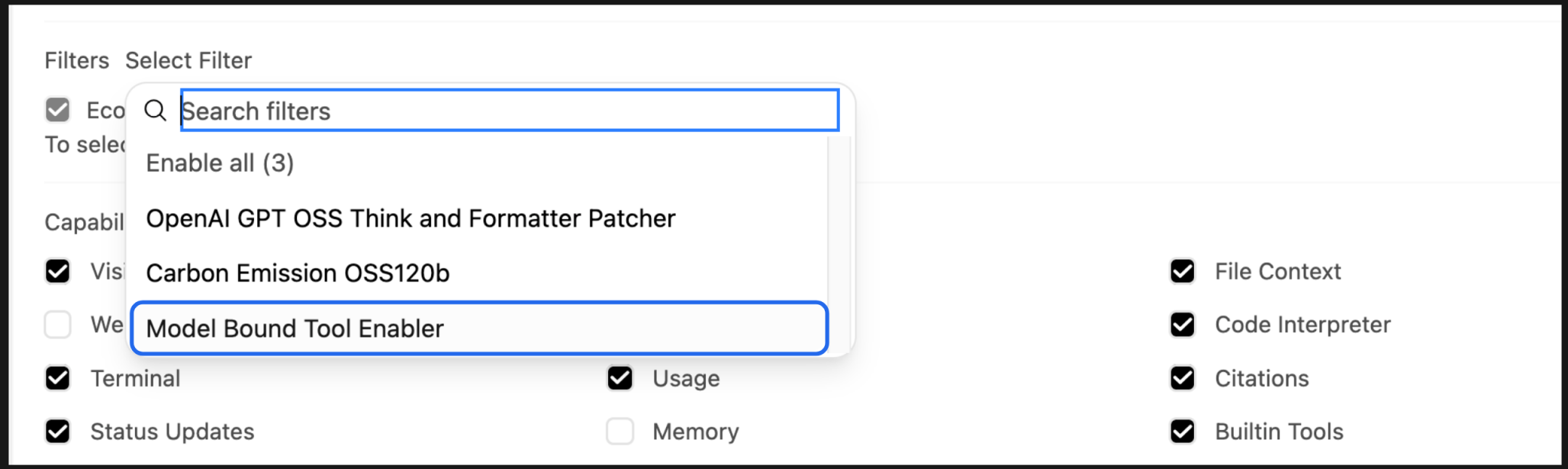
Charts is a tool for the Sandbox that renders chart elements in-chat using an HTML5 canvas via Chart.js cdn

# Update Model for Tool Calling



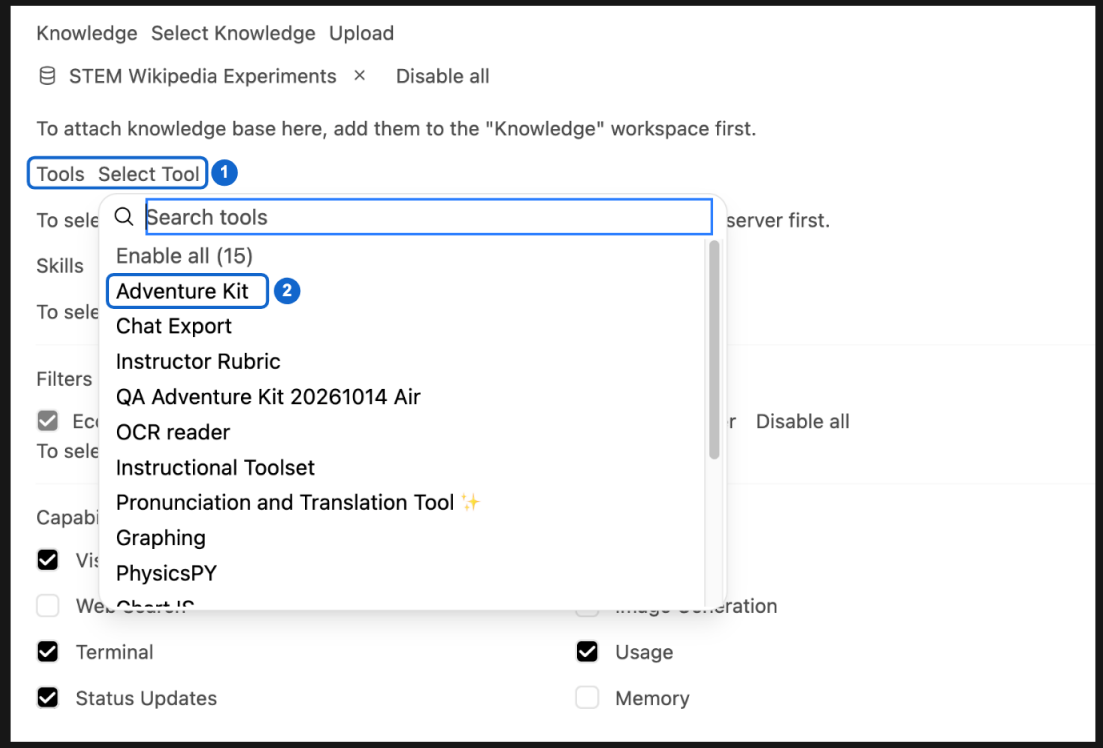
# Enable Filter

Enable **Model Bound Tool Enabler** on your model card.
Why: It restores attached tools when a chat omits them.



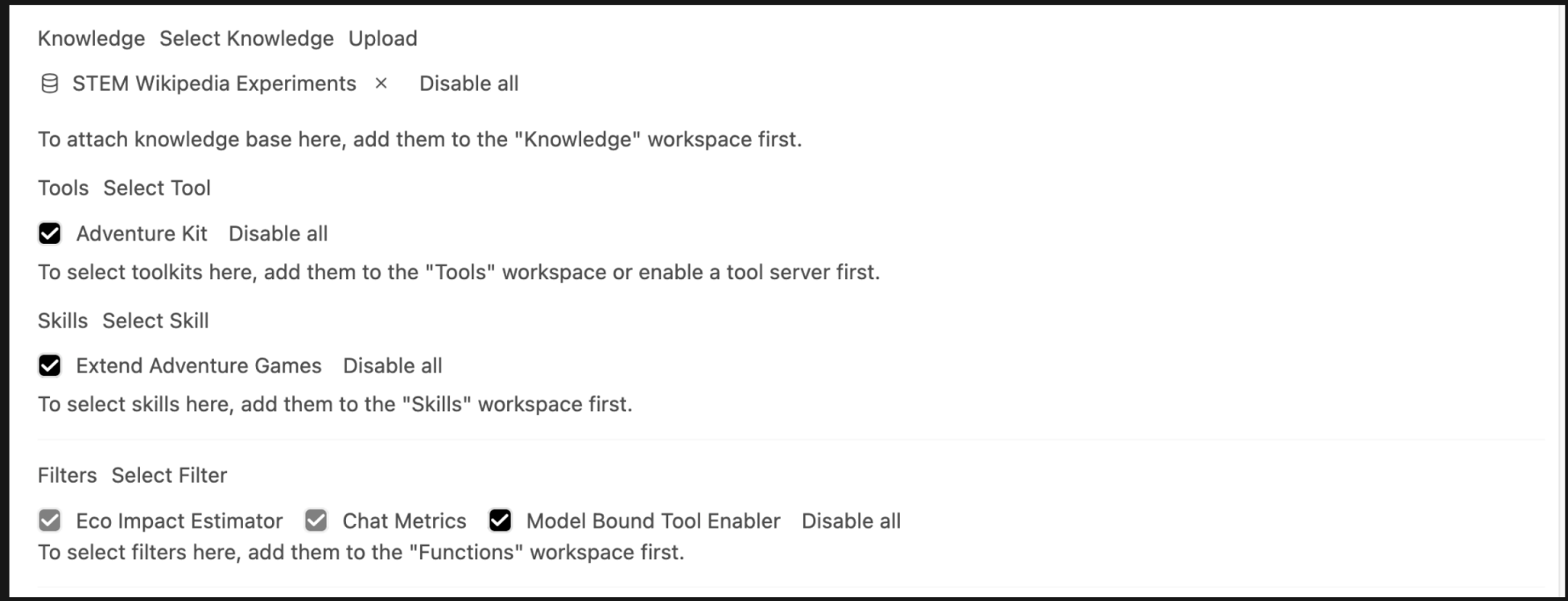
# Add the ‘Adventure Kit’ tool

In this same model card, open **Tools → Select Tool**
Choose **Adventure Kit** · Confirm **Extend Adventure Games** remains selected
Add next prompt instruction, then click **Save & Update** before testing



# Model Card Check-In

Ensure that your model card has a knowledge collection, tool, skill, and filter configured like the image below.



# Add Skill Instructions to the Bottom of Your System Prompt

Copy prompt

```
Load the extend_adventure_games skill and follow it on every turn, calling the
adventure_kit tool only as the skill directs. Use no other skills or tools.
```

# Test Your Adventure

Run your updated adventure game

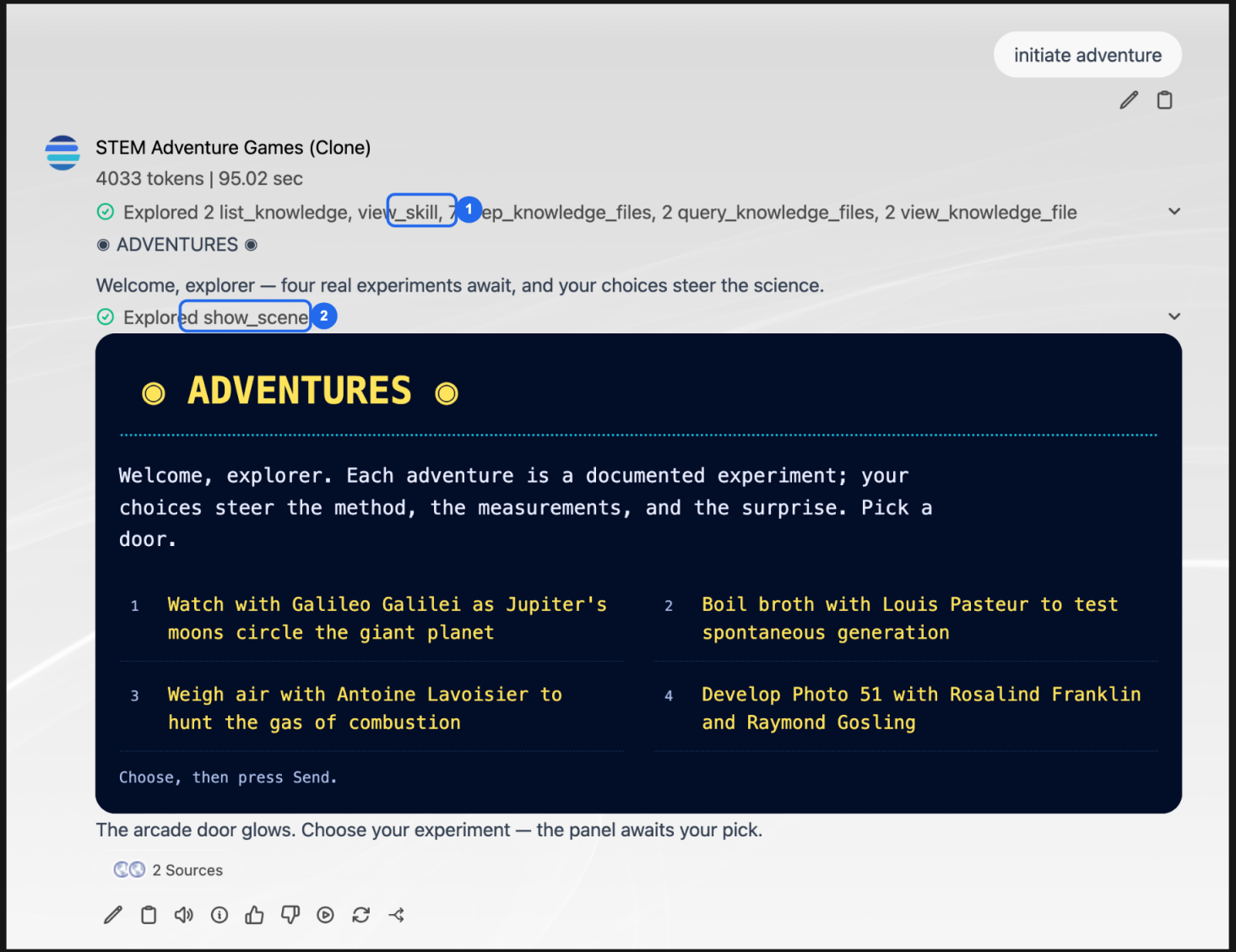
Verify configured skill and tool are called appropriately

Then play the rest of your game

# Observe Game Results

① Check skill call
② Check tool call

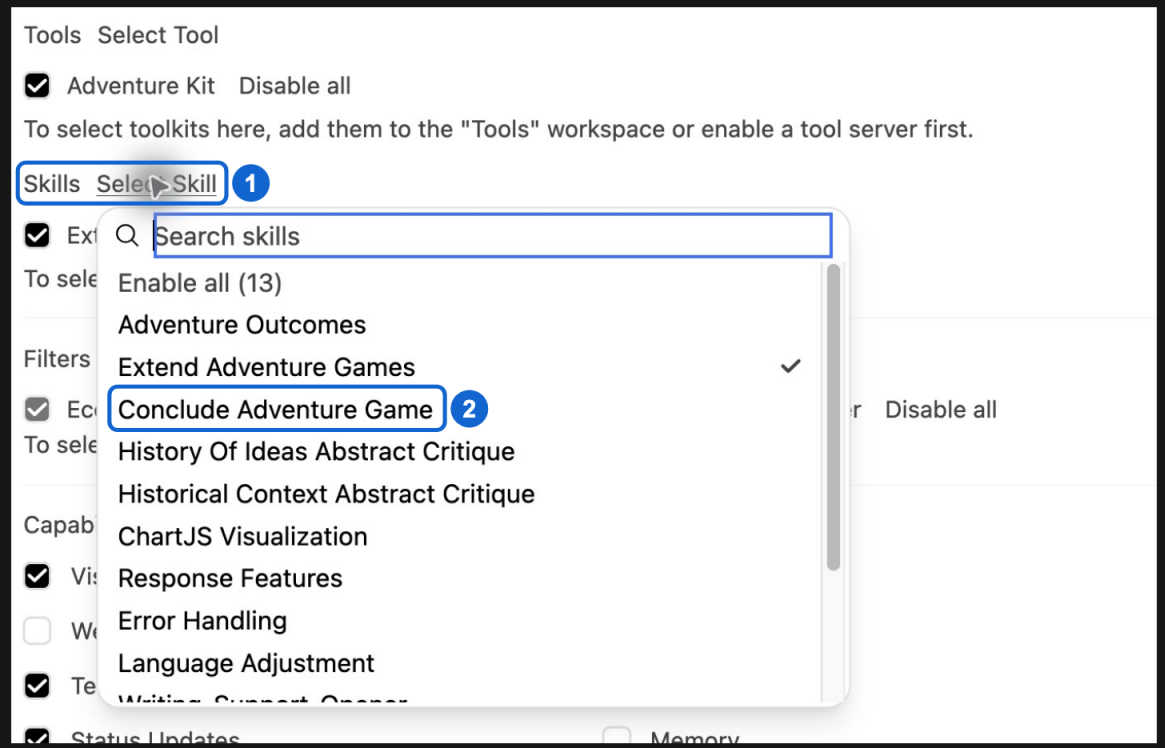
Open details to confirm selected skill



# Explore Other Skills

After your first adventure works, try **Adventure Outcomes** or **Conclude Adventure Game** if available

Read saved instructions · Change one item · Save your model card and compare results



# Choose Your Task

## Revise One Item

Copy complete tool code or skill instructions

Describe an observed problem and one change

Copy tool code · Skill instructions

## Create Your Own

Choose your own tool or skill

Specify purpose, required input, and expected result

# Work With Support

Open **CAIL Workspace Support**
Paste original content or your new task, system prompt, and required sources
Request complete content, an explanation, and one test · Copy request



# Adapt Your Adventure

Introduce a lesson plan, learning outcome, or disciplinary focus to your use of **CAIL Workspace Support** card

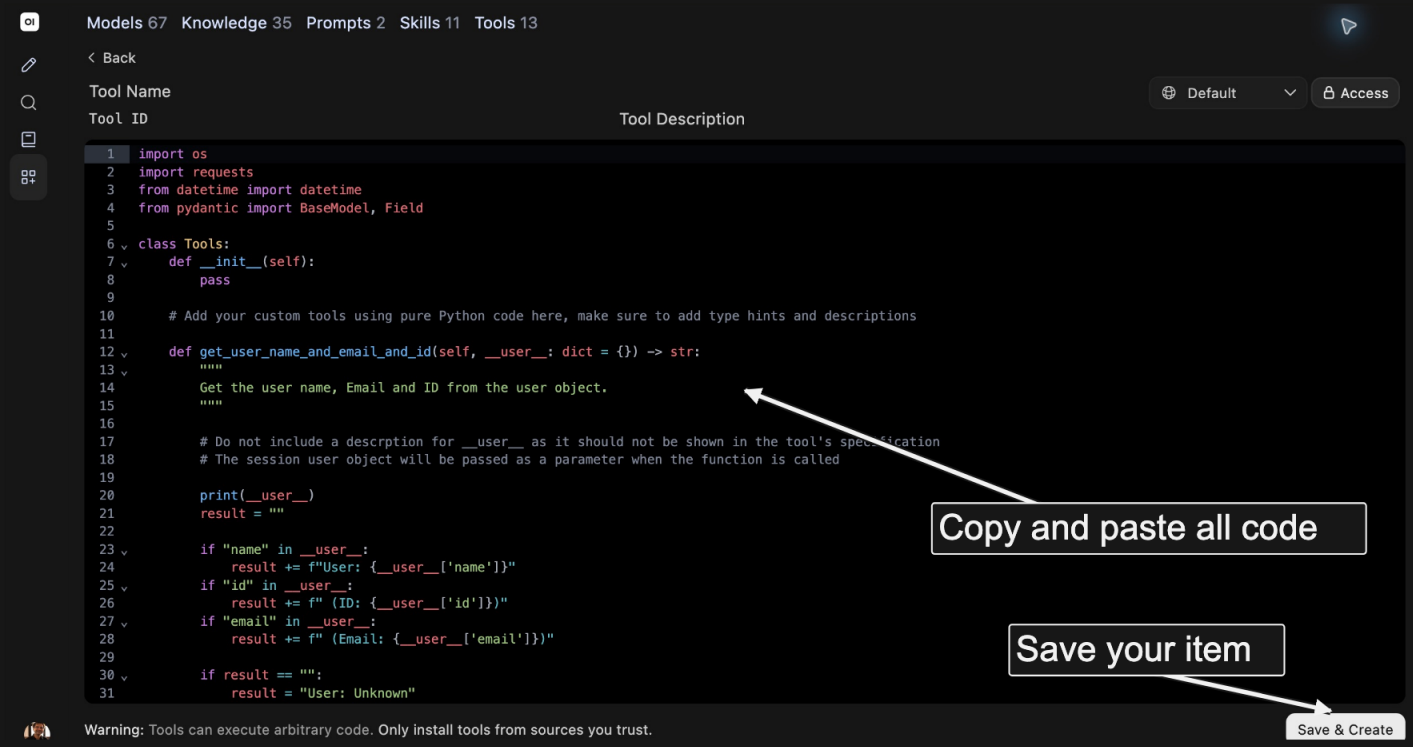
Prompted to generate a skill and/or tool that continues to support or further extends your adventure game, either adapting an existing skill or tool, or making your own.

# Add Tools or Skills

Copy and paste all code, then save your item.

On your model card, select your new tool or skill.

Update the system prompt to tell the model which tool to use and when. Save the model card.



# Series Reflections

What task in your teaching or research could benefit from a skill or tool?

Would you be interested in joining our coworking session on October 29, 2–4pm, to build your adventure into a collection so that we can showcase our work over the course of the series?

What would you develop next with the prompts, knowledge collections, skills, and tools you have explored?